MS

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CASE STUDY · ROOFING · GOOGLE ADS

Cost per Conversion Down 54%. Conversions Up 3×.

How restructuring a roofing company's Google Ads account turned wasted clicks into far more tracked conversions, at a much lower cost for each one.

CLIENT Roofing contractor (name withheld)	INDUSTRY Roofing
CHANNEL Google Ads	REPORTING PERIOD May 30 – Dec 26, 2025
DATA SOURCE Google Ads account reports	PRIMARY GOAL More conversions at a lower cost

-54%
Cost per conversion
$65.74 → $30.21

~3×
Tracked conversions
535 → 1.7K

$11.09
Cost per conversion in the best window (19.41% conversion rate)

STARTING PERIOD MAY 30 – AUG 8, 2025 VS OPTIMIZED PERIOD JUL 21 – SEP 17, 2025 · SOURCE: GOOGLE ADS

THE SHORT VERSION

Most roofing Google Ads accounts don't have a traffic problem. They have an efficiency problem.

Roofing is one of the most competitive and expensive categories in local advertising. When every click costs real money, it matters a great deal who is clicking.

The pattern is familiar: the phone rings, but it's someone asking about a job, a homeowner two towns outside your area, or a person who wants a free price for a tiny patch. Reports show plenty of clicks. The calendar shows few inspections. So the owner decides, "Google Ads doesn't work for roofing."

Usually the platform isn't the problem. The way the account is built is. This case study walks through the numbers from one roofing company's account, what changed, and how each conversion became dramatically cheaper.

SELF-CHECK

Does this sound like your account?

- [ ] You pay for clicks from people looking for roofing jobs, not roofing work
- [ ] Leads are low-quality or unqualified: wrong service, wrong area, no real intent
- [ ] Roofing leads feel expensive and you can't pinpoint why
- [ ] Too many tire-kickers who only want "a price"
- [ ] Your search terms report is full of queries you'd never choose
- [ ] Keyword targeting is broad and matches things you don't sell
- [ ] Your negative keyword list is thin, or doesn't exist
- [ ] Plenty of clicks, but not enough calls
- [ ] Ads show in areas you don't actually serve
- [ ] Lots of small repairs, too few roof replacement leads
- [ ] Conversion tracking is unreliable or counts everything
- [ ] You can't tell which leads turned into real jobs

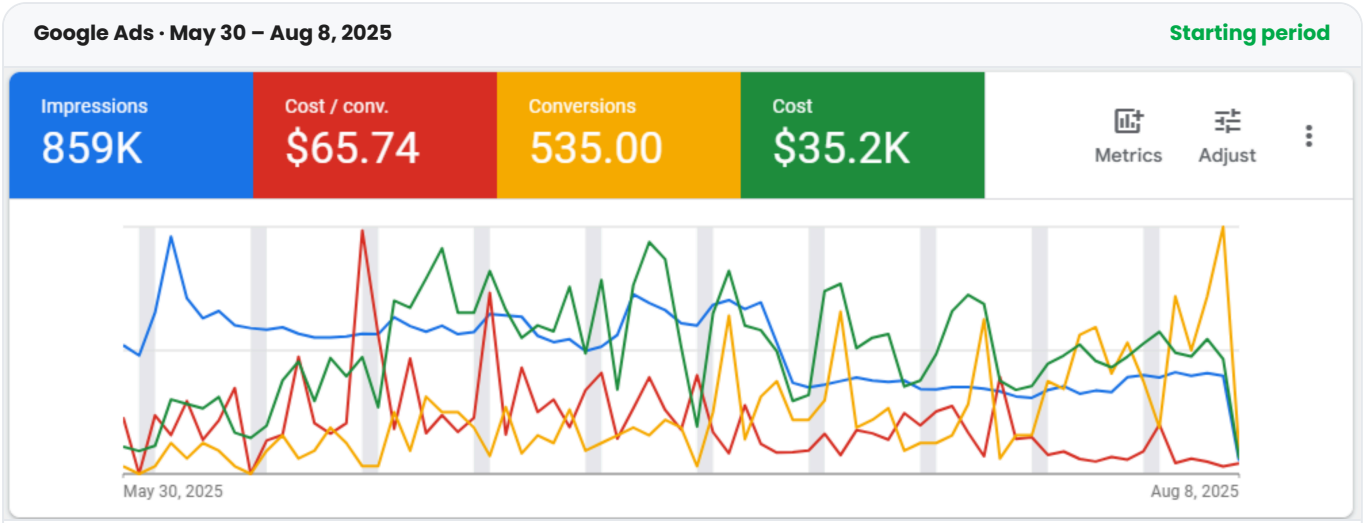
If you ticked **three or more**, the rest of this case study is written for you.

THE CHALLENGE

The starting point: $65.74 for every conversion

From May 30 to Aug 8, 2025, the account spent $35.2K and earned 535 tracked conversions. That is a lot of money for a modest return, and the daily cost per conversion swung sharply, which is what an account without tight control looks like.

$35.2K	859K	535	$65.74
Ad spend	Impressions	Tracked conversions	Cost per conversion



The red cost-per-conversion line spikes repeatedly through the period: spend was not yet tied tightly to results.

Where roofing budgets typically leak (the six things I audit first)

Irrelevant clicks 01

Broad matching with few negatives pulls in job seekers, DIYers, and suppliers.

Budget gone before a homeowner calls.

Leads that never become jobs 02

Renters, out-of-area callers, and the wrong service type.

Your team's time, wasted.

Too few roof replacements 03

Small repairs share budget with high-value replacement searches.

Busy phones, small jobs.

Clicks without calls 04

Generic ads and pages with no clear next step on mobile.

Paid visits that leave.

Wrong locations 05

Loose settings show ads outside the real service area.

Calls you turn down.

Weak conversion tracking 06

Everything counts as a win, so Google learns the wrong signals.

Automation chasing junk.

STRATEGY & CAMPAIGN APPROACH

Build the account around buyer intent, not traffic volume

Every change was tested against one question: does this help the right homeowner find the business, call, and be worth talking to?

1 Separate by intent

Roof replacement, repair, emergency leak, and inspection searches get their own structure so budget follows job value.

2 Control the keywords

Tighter match types around high-intent roofing terms, so spend stops drifting into loosely related searches.

3 Layer the negatives

A structured negative keyword list filters out job seekers, DIY, free-seekers, suppliers, and unrelated services.

4 Target only where you work

Ads limited to real service areas, with exclusions and location settings that favor people physically there.

5 Qualify before the click

Ads and landing pages that name the service and area, with a call-first path on mobile.

6 Track what matters

Calls and forms measured as conversions, so Google learns from real inquiries instead of empty clicks.

Campaign structure for roofing

Roofing Google Ads Account

Roof Replacement	Roof Repair	Emergency / Leak	Inspection / Estimate
Highest-value jobs. Budget protected first.	Controlled so small jobs don't eat the budget.	Urgent searches, call-first ads.	Early-stage homeowners, qualified by area.

Negative keyword layers: the categories filtered out

Jobs & careers · Salary & training · DIY & how-to · Free / cheapest · Wholesale & supplies · Unrelated trades · Out-of-area locations · Competitor job boards

Google Ads optimizes toward whatever you tell it counts as a win. If every call counts the same, it finds you more of the **cheapest** calls, not the **best** ones. That is why tracking comes first.

What I watch instead of clicks

Cost per conversion · conversion rate · relevance of the search terms spending money · spend by location · how budget is split between high-value and low-value work.

OPTIMIZATION PROCESS

How the numbers moved, window by window

Results rarely come from one big change. They come from a disciplined sequence, then a weekly habit. Here is how the account's cost per conversion moved across the reporting windows.

MAY 30 – AUG 8 · $65.74 PER CONVERSION

Audit and stop the leaks

Reviewed search terms, locations, devices, and conversion actions. Added negative keywords and corrected location settings.

JUL 17 – AUG 15 · $30.58 PER CONVERSION

Rebuild around intent and fix tracking

Restructured into intent-based campaigns, rewrote ads per job type, and made conversions represent real inquiries.

JUL 21 – SEP 17 · $30.21 PER CONVERSION

Refine with real data

Mined search terms weekly and shifted budget toward what converted. Spend grew while cost per conversion held.

AUG 18 – SEP 25 · $11.09 PER CONVERSION

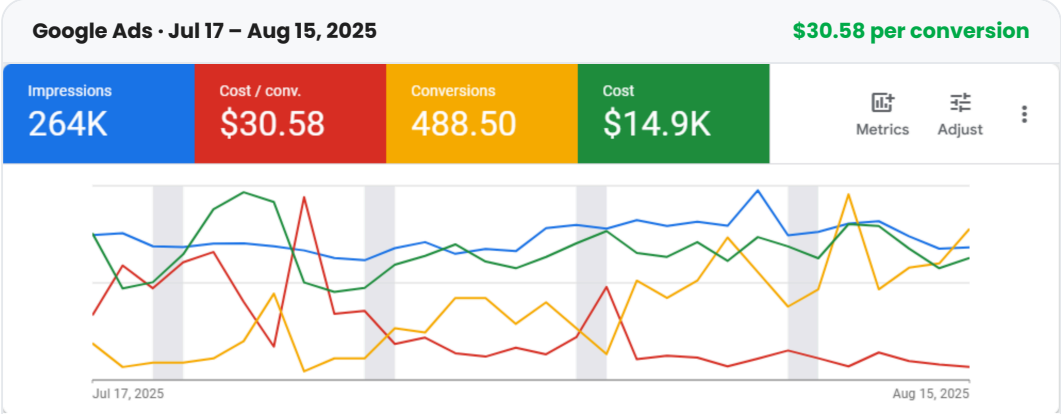
Peak efficiency

The best window in the account: a 19.41% conversion rate and 895 conversions on $9.93K.

OCT 1 – DEC 26 · $106K SPEND

Scale what's proven

Budget increased once the structure and tracking were working. See page 7.



Cost per conversion (red) drifts down through the window while impressions and conversions hold or rise.

The weekly optimization loop

Review search terms | Add negatives | Check call and lead quality | Reallocate budget | Test ads and pages

RESULTS

Spend went up. Cost per conversion went way down.

The clearest comparison is between the starting period and the optimized period. Budget grew, but conversions grew much faster, so every conversion cost far less.

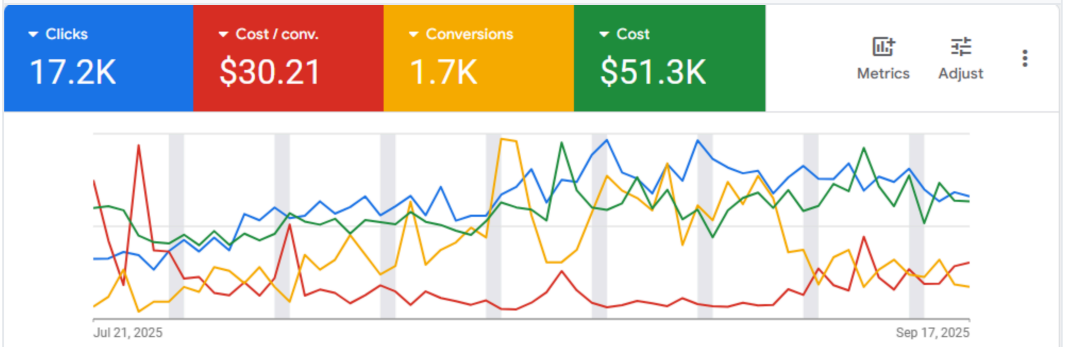
Metric	Starting period May 30 – Aug 8	Optimized period Jul 21 – Sep 17	Change
Ad spend	$35.2K	$51.3K	+46%
Tracked conversions	535	1.7K	**~3×**
Cost per conversion	**$65.74**	**$30.21**	**-54%**

$11.09
Cost per conversion, Aug 18 – Sep 25

19.41%
Conversion rate in the same window

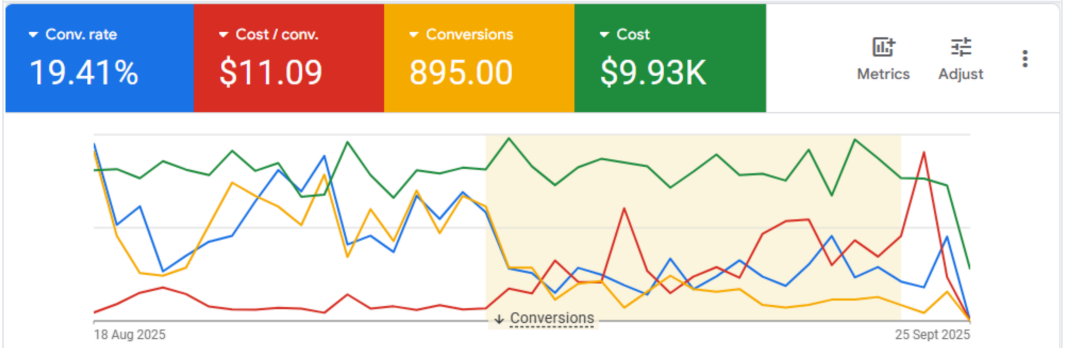
895
Conversions on $9.93K spend

Google Ads · Jul 21 – Sep 17, 2025 — **Optimized period**



1.7K conversions at $30.21 each on $51.3K. Cost per conversion (red) mostly stays low as clicks and spend climb.

Google Ads · Aug 18 – Sep 25, 2025 — **Peak efficiency window**



19.41% conversion rate and $11.09 per conversion: the strongest stretch in the account.

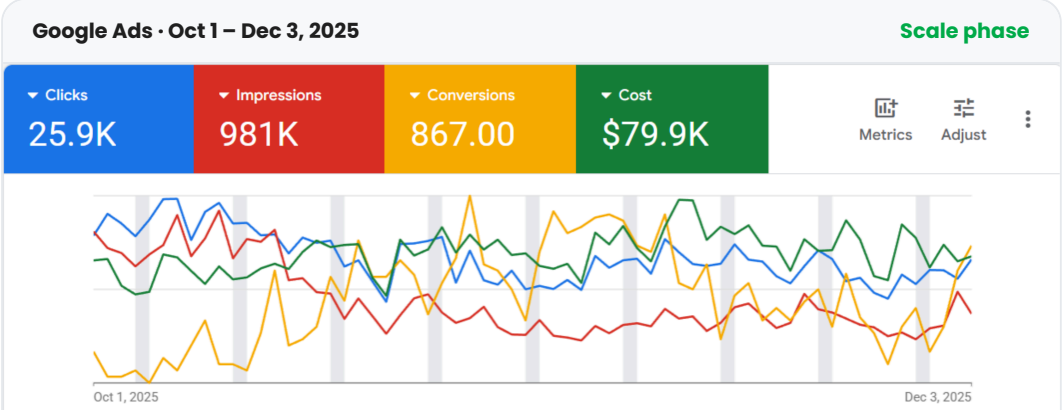
Reporting windows are exported from Google Ads and overlap, so figures are not additive. Conversions are as tracked in the client's Google Ads account.

SCALING UP

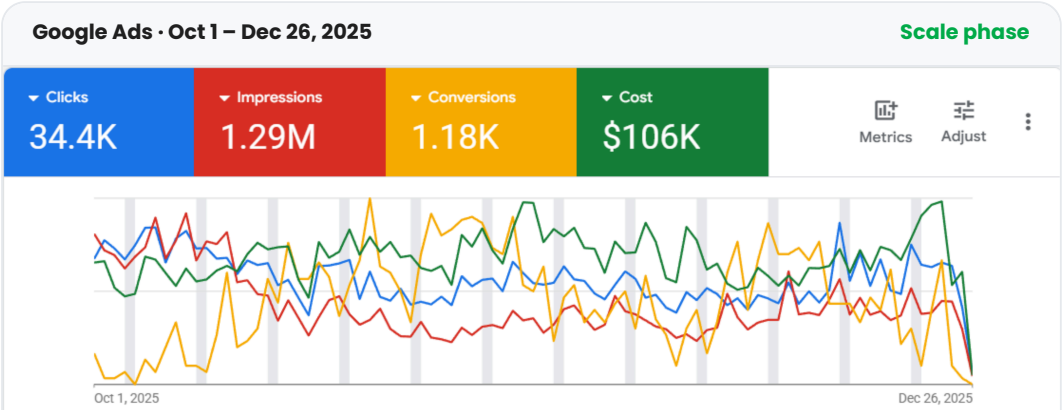
More budget, more volume

With the structure and tracking in place, spend was increased through Q4. Across the quarter the account generated over a million impressions and more than a thousand tracked conversions.

Metric	Oct 1 – Dec 3	Oct 1 – Dec 26
Ad spend	$79.9K	$106K
Clicks	25.9K	34.4K
Impressions	981K	1.29M
Tracked conversions	**867**	**1.18K**
Cost per conversion (spend ÷ conversions)	≈ $92	≈ $90



25.9K clicks and 867 conversions on $79.9K.



34.4K clicks, 1.29M impressions, and 1.18K conversions on $106K.

Scaling buys volume, and it also raises the cost of each conversion, as the numbers above show. That is why I scale only on top of solid tracking and keep reviewing search terms every week.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

What roofing owners can learn from this

1 **Cost per conversion is the number to watch.**

Here it fell from $65.74 to $30.21 while spend rose. That is efficiency, not just a bigger budget.

2 **Negative keywords are a profit tool.**

Reviewing search terms every week keeps job seekers and tire-kickers out of your budget.

3 **Separate high-value work from small jobs.**

When replacement searches have their own structure, the budget can follow the money.

4 **Location precision removes waste.**

Show ads only where you work, and to people who are actually there.

5 **Scale on top of solid tracking.**

Count real calls and real leads first. Volume is easy to buy; efficient volume is built.

FREE GOOGLE ADS AUDIT

Think your roofing ads look like this? Let's look at your account.

I'll review where your budget is going and tell you plainly what's working, what isn't, and what I'd change first.

- ✓ Search terms and wasted spend
- ✓ Negative keyword coverage
- ✓ Conversion and call tracking
- ✓ Keyword and match type structure
- ✓ Location targeting
- ✓ Roof replacement lead opportunity

Book Your Free Call →

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